

geeks. The categories listed there are: Microsoft, Apple, Internet, Gamers, Digital Living, Virus and Spyware, Hardware, Software, IT Pro, Developer, Storage, OS, Database, Security, Programming, Web Development, Networking, Other and Community. Each of these categories is further divided into various sub-sections and guarantee that you will find the category of your choice.

Posing A Question

When the user asks a question in the relevant sub-category of a site, he gets answered by the experts. The user is then expected to choose one or more of the best answers that sorted his/her problem. When the best answer is selected, the user is allowed to grade the author of the answer in the order of "A" being excellent and "C" being average. The user can assign a point value to the question, the maximum being 500 points. According to the Expert Exchange guidelines, the maximum point value for a question can be 500 only if the question requires a high degree of skill and specialisation and saves the user time and money. The minimum point value that can be awarded is 20.

Look And Feel

The site has a very modern look to it. The navigation system is easy to use and the colours are pleasing to the eye. Being a site for the *geeks*, it seems a tad strange that the site should have such a graphic heavy interface. The system of awarding points has been custom built and is patented by the Web site.

Criticism

Like most popular Web sites Experts Exchange has had its share of critics. Users of the site complain that premium membership users often award the maximum number of points for their posted queries in order to get faster replies, in spite of the queries being of intermediate or beginner level. The fact that the Web site seems to hide its free membership service from the general public and only allows the same on the notion that you consider yourself an expert seems biased to us.